3. You need to implement the cipher yourself. By that we mean to say that if you're going to use your own cipher on your computer, you need to write the program yourself as well. This can take time and can be imperfect or make it insecure if the person who is writing the algorithm skips a step.
4. If you encrypt something using your own cipher and then forget the algorithm, or lose the program you use to encrypt and decrypt data, you're literally locked out of your own data. No other program on this planet is going to help you there. Make sure you have saved the algorithm and the program's source code somewhere safe other than your own computer (cloud services are a good choice), so that if you ever need it back, you can have it.

Advantages of using your own cipher

Reality is that no one wants to do anything unless it has got at least some advantages. So what are the advantages to having your own cipher? The first advantage (and the only big one) is that it's yours. You know how it works and you alone know it. So if you're going to encrypt something using your own cipher and send the data (or store it), you alone will know how to decrypt it! For a cipher to be cracked, the key needs to be known; but that's not the only thing needed. You also need to know the algorithm. If someone gets the key but does not know the algorithm, you're still relatively safe.

You can implement your own cipher as a program which can be used to 'password protect' data – the password you enter should act as the key which can then decrypt the data. If the wrong key is supplied, the decrypted result would be garbage. As you can see, this technique can be used with only what you use; after all it's your own cipher and you would have wanted to use it only for yourself. Of course you can give the cipher and the program you created to your friend, but the cipher would not be accepted as IETF for being utilized in *HTTPS* anyway and it would remain private.